

The economics of AI: Fewer jobs, higher profits, wider gaps

In the world of AI, people whose skills are automated risk being displaced or experiencing stagnation. The workforce is hollowed out as mid-level skill jobs disappear first. This is already apparent.

AI might change who is able to prosper. Technology advances more quickly than legislation. AI is no different. Systems are firmly established by the time regulations are drafted. Governments find it difficult to strike a balance between control and innovation. In a technology that shapes opportunity, power, and cognition, ethics cannot be an afterthought.

What society gains—and quietly loses

AI offers undeniable benefits: efficiency, accessibility, medical breakthroughs, scientific discovery.

But society risks losing:

- Deep focus
- Apprenticeship-based learning
- Human-centred judgement
- Intellectual independence

Progress is not free. Every convenience extracts a subtle cost.

Humans cannot compete with machines on speed, scale, or memory. But competition may be the wrong lens. The future belongs not to those who outcompete machines—but to those who complement them. Creativity, ethics, leadership, emotional intelligence, and purpose remain uniquely human—if cultivated intentionally.

As AI accelerates, the central question is not technological—but philosophical: Are we building machines to serve humanity or reshaping humanity to serve machines? The answer will define the next century. AI is neither a saviour nor the villain. It is a mirror—reflecting human priorities, incentives, and values. Machines may learn faster than humans. But whether humans become obsolete is not a technological inevitability—it is a collective choice. Progress should make humans more human—not less. The clock is not ticking loudly. It is ticking quietly. And that is what makes this moment so dangerous—and so important. **END** 🐼

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